

--- layout: brief title: "Brief: NextPatient - Staff Software Engineer: Legacy Integration & Platform Architecture (Ruby/Rails)" description: "Tailored 1-page executive pitch brief for Staff Software Engineer: Legacy Integration & Platform Architecture (Ruby/Rails) at NextPatient." permalink: /exports/briefs/nextpatient-staff-software-engineer/ breadcrumb: "NextPatient Brief" breadcrumb_parent_name: Exports breadcrumb_parent_url: /exports/ brief_company: "NextPatient" brief_role: "Staff Software Engineer: Legacy Integration & Platform Architecture (Ruby/Rails)" sitemap: false robots: noindex,nofollow body_class: ats-resume --- **Target Role:** Staff Software Engineer: Legacy Integration & Platform Architecture (Ruby/Rails) **Company:** NextPatient **Comp Range:** \$250,000: \$300,000 / yr (Remote, Full-time) **Tone Calibration:** Understated, fact-dense, zero-fluff. Written for engineering leadership & technical screeners. --- ## 1. Mission & Architectural Alignment NextPatient's mandate: **decoupling modern patient experiences (scheduling, check-in, waitlists, payments) from dated, legacy doctor's office EHR systems**: is a direct match for my 25+ year track record in **System Cartography, legacy subsystem decoupling, and zero-downtime platform safety**. ### Why This Match Works (3 Grounded Signals): 1. **High-Consequence System Integration & Uptime Protection**: Extensive background in 4D System Cartography and operational risk modeling, mapping dark dependencies, lateral state mutations, and establishing release verification gates across deployment pipelines to protect mission-critical uptime. 2. **Strangler-Fig Decoupling & API Boundary Design**: At OneMain Financial, refactored high-volume financial customer acquisition flows spanning legacy database layers, multi-service Rails state machines, and third-party API supply chains: eliminating hidden lateral state mutations and cross-service blind spots. 3. **OpenTelemetry & Dark Telemetry Illumination**: Founded and technically led the enterprise OpenTelemetry initiative at OneMain, converting dark legacy microservice behavior into empirical telemetry and quantifiable risk governance. --- ## 2. Fit Matrix & Seniority Calibration | Dimension | NextPatient Expectation | Mike's Grounded Evidence | Fit Evaluation | :- -- | :- -- | :- -- | :- -- | **Legacy Integration** | Plug modern SaaS into legacy EHRs without breaking live clinical operations. | Strangler-fig API decoupling across financial monoliths; zero-downtime data migrations. | **Direct Match** | **Backend & Stack** | Heavy Ruby on Rails, PostgreSQL, background jobs, zero-downtime migrations. | 25+ years Ruby/Rails, PostgreSQL (including pgvector), Sidekiq/Redis, AWS/Kubernetes. | **Core Stack Match** | **Platform Ownership** | Staff IC leadership, responsibility realignment, developer velocity enablement. | Founded and technically led ACQ Enablement team at OneMain; led cross-team architecture reviews. | **Staff/Principal IC Match** | **Culture & Alumni** | High technical autonomy, async documentation, craftsmanship rigor. | Groupon alumnus; founded Software Craftsmanship McHenry County (820+ members); author of *Panoramic View*. | **Cultural Parity** | --- ## 3. Proven Case Studies for NextPatient Leadership 1. **OneMain Financial Acquisition Lane Realignment (2021 to 2026)**: - **Challenge**: Implicit lateral state mutations across multi-step Rails state machines caused persistent data corruptions in high-volume loan acquisition flows. - **Action**: Refactored workflow state transitions, mapped seven acquisition channels, engineered an automated 5-phase PII deletion engine across 30+ tables, founded ACQ Enablement, and deployed enterprise OpenTelemetry tracing across microservice boundaries. - **Outcome**: Diagnosed and eliminated a persistent 4% silent traffic drop via DynamoDB session storage remediation, unblocked engineering streams, and built the Enterprise Trace. - **Reference**: [case-studies/index.html#onemain-acquisition](https://www.just3ws.com/case-studies/) 2. **SK Holdings & Real Estate Platform Modernization**: - **Challenge**: Monolithic Rails application experiencing search bottlenecks and Sidekiq background queue congestion under high transaction volume. - **Action**: Upgraded core Rails versions with zero downtime, restructured relational database indexes, and modernized asynchronous worker queues. - **Outcome**: Restored application throughput and reduced queue latency across search and transaction pipelines. - **Reference**: [history/index.html#sk-holdings](https://www.just3ws.com/history/) --- ## 4. 30-Second Interview Calibration (The "Answer, Frame, and Pause" Rule) > "I specialize in strangler-fig modernization: connecting modern user interfaces and SaaS platforms to fragile legacy backends without disrupting live production operations. At OneMain Financial, I led the Acquisition architecture, mapping seven ingress channels, eliminating a 4% silent traffic drop via DynamoDB session remediation, and safely purging legacy PII across 30+ tables. NextPatient faces the classic challenge of modernizing clinical patient workflows against legacy EHR systems, and my background is built specifically to de-risk those integrations." > > (Pause & Hook): "I can dive deeper into how we decoupled multi-step Rails workflows, or we can look at how we safely migrated legacy database records. Which direction would you prefer to explore?" --- ## 5. Authoritative Verification Links * **System Cartography Essay**: just3ws.com/2026/08/29/system-cartography-how-to-map-a-ten-year-old-monolith/ * **Portfolio & Case Studies**: just3ws.com/case-studies/ * **Canonical Résumé**: just3ws.com/resume * **GitHub Profile**: github.com/just3ws